VOL. I · NO. 8
WEDNESDAY EDITION

MUMBAI
EDITED FOR SHARVIN SHAH

# The Jarvis Gazette

All the world, before your coffee.

WEDNESDAY - NOVEMBER 11, 2026 | MUMBAI, INDIA | EDITION NO. 8

## ₹ Indian Money

STOCK MARKET · GOLD & SILVER · YOUR WALLET

| SENSEX · LAST CLOSE (MON) | NIFTY 50 · LAST CLOSE (MON) | GIFT NIFTY · TUE 10:30 AM | RUPEE · PER $ | GOLD · 24K MUMBAI |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 81,107 | 25,045 | 25,257 | ₹93.93 | ₹1,44,600 |
| ▲ 0.13% | ▲ 0.23% | ▲ 0.57% | Monday close | per 10 g, Mon |

THE BIG STORY · BACK TO WORK

# Dalal Street reopens after the holiday with two messages to digest: cheaper oil, and a hot American price report

*India's markets were shut on Tuesday for Balipratipada. While they slept, a hint from Gujarat pointed to a bright start, but Wall Street then slipped overnight.*

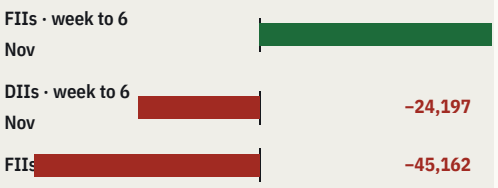
The last time Indian shares traded, on Monday, the Sensex closed at **81,106.65** and the Nifty at **25,044.65**, their best closing levels since February. Trading resumes at 9:15 this morning, and the market has a day and a half of world news to catch up on.

**The good news** came on Tuesday. **GIFT Nifty**, a version of the Nifty that trades in Gujarat's GIFT City even on Indian holidays, rose **141 points (0.57%) to 25,257** by 10:30 AM and was up nearly **1.19%** by lunchtime, the Free Press Journal reported. That's a strong hint of a cheerful opening. The reason: oil kept falling after President Trump said new strikes on Iran were unlikely, and Asian markets jumped (Japan's Nikkei rose about 2.9% in early trade, Korea's KOSPI about 4.4%).

**The less good news** came on Tuesday night. America's prices rose faster than expected in October, and New York's shares fell, led by a 5.5% drop in chip giant Nvidia (page 2). So expect the opening to be a tug-of-war between cheaper oil, which India loves, and fears of higher US interest rates, which tend to pull foreign money out of countries like ours.

**Watch this:** foreign investors bought a huge **₹45,960 crore** of Indian shares in the week to 6 November, on 14 straight days of buying, Kotak Neo reports. That followed a month (October) in which they sold ₹45,162 crore.

### ⓘ WHO BOUGHT, WHO SOLD (₹ CRORE)




Foreign funds reversed October's whole outflow in one week. Exchange data via Kotak Neo.

### THAT WEEK IN ONE LINE

- ▲ Nifty **+8.6%** · about 1,977 points
- ▲ Sensex **+8.8%** · about 6,568 points
- ▼ Next holiday: **Tue 24 Nov**, Guru Nanak Jayanti

### ⓘ NEW TO THIS? WORDS FROM TODAY'S STORY

**GIFT Nifty**
Nifty contracts traded at GIFT City in Gujarat for almost 21 hours a day. It hints where the real Nifty will open.

**FII and DII**
Foreign institutional investors (funds from abroad) and domestic ones (Indian mutual funds, insurers).

**Crore**
One crore is 1,00,00,000 (ten million). So ₹45,960 crore is about ₹460 billion.

**IPO**
Initial public offering: when a company first sells its shares to the public and lists on the stock exchange.

### WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Gold had no new price on Tuesday because of the holiday; the last Mumbai rate was **₹1,44,600** per 10 g of 24-carat gold (Monday, Goodreturns via HDFC Sky), with silver at ₹2,05,000 a kg. Abroad, gold held near **$4,120** an ounce. If you are planning to buy wedding gold, a hot US inflation number usually pushes gold down a little, so a few days' patience can pay.

### VARSITY-STYLE EXPLAINER: HOW CAN A HOLIDAY MARKET STILL MOVE?

Think of GIFT Nifty as a weather forecast for the Nifty. Big investors abroad keep trading it while Mumbai rests, betting on where Indian shares will be next. It is not the real thing, and the open can differ, but it's usually the best clue you'll get over breakfast.

BUSINESS BRIEFS

IPO
### Coal India's $1 billion child

Coal India plans to sell about $1 billion of shares in its unit Mahanadi Coalfields through an IPO, after market regulator Sebi's clearance, Kotak Neo reports.

IPO
### MakeMyTrip India gets a nod

The Indian arm of travel site MakeMyTrip has Sebi's approval to float an IPO, HDFC Sky reports. No dates or prices yet.

RESULTS
### Whirlpool sells more, charges more

Whirlpool of India's September-quarter revenue rose 14% to ₹1,873 crore, and it is raising prices by 5% from November, Kotak Neo reports.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Shape tomorrow's paper

Scan with your phone camera to rate today's edition and tell the editor what you want more or less of. Tomorrow's paper reads your answers before it is written.

Or tap here to open the feedback desk

Sources: Free Press Journal (GIFT Nifty, Asian markets) · HDFC Sky (holiday, Monday closes, next holiday) · DSIJ closing bell · Business Today (holiday) · Kotak Neo (FII and DII flows) · HDFC Sky / Goodreturns (gold) · HDFC Sky (silver) · HDFC Sky / PTI (rupee) · Kotak Neo (Coal India) · HDFC Sky (MakeMyTrip) · Kotak Neo (Whirlpool). Explainers draw on Zerodha Varsity. Not investment advice.

# World Money

AMERICA'S PRICE CHECK · CHIPS SLIDE · OIL KEEPS FALLING

THE BIG STORY · PRICES RUN HOT

## American prices rose faster than expected in October, and Wall Street began to fear an interest-rate rise

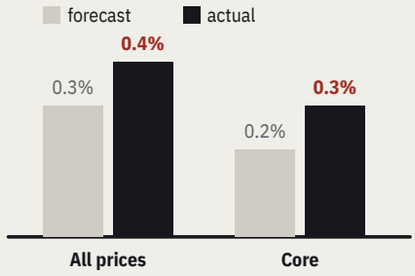
*The consumer price index went up 0.4% in a single month, against 0.3% forecast. Shares fell, Nvidia slumped, and US borrowing costs climbed towards 5%.*

Every month America's Bureau of Labor Statistics checks the price of a typical shopping basket, from rent to petrol to groceries. In October that basket cost **0.4% more** than in September, the BLS said on Tuesday. Economists had expected 0.3%. "Core" prices, which leave out food and fuel because they jump around, rose **0.3%** against a forecast of 0.2%.

Housing ("shelter") was the biggest driver, making up more than 30% of the rise. Food rose 0.5% and petrol 1%, after a 9.1% jump in September, CNBC reports. One oddity: the BLS did not publish the usual figure comparing prices with a year earlier, because of data gaps from the 2025 government shutdown. An analyst quoted by Fox Business estimates it at about 4%, but that is not official.

**Why shares fell:** when prices run hot, the Federal Reserve, America's central bank, may *raise* interest rates to cool them, and traders now see that as more likely in December. The **S&P 500** fell 0.38% to 7,520.93, the **Dow** 0.30% to 52,231.89 and the **Nasdaq** 0.74% to 25,065.87. **Nvidia**, the maker of AI chips, dropped about 5.5% and is down nearly 30% since early October, though rivals AMD and Broadcom rose.

### FORECAST VS REALITY · OCTOBER




Monthly change, seasonally adjusted. BLS; forecasts from CNBC's survey.

### US 10-YEAR BORROWING COST




The interest America pays to borrow for 10 years. Higher means dearer loans worldwide.

### WHY SHOULD SOMEONE IN MUMBAI CARE?

When US interest rates look set to rise, big global funds can earn more simply by parking money in America, so some pull out of countries like India. That can weaken the rupee, already near ₹94 to the dollar. The silver lining is oil: **Brent** fell another 1.17% to **$91.49** a barrel, and every dollar off oil saves India money, because it buys most of its crude from abroad.

### JARGON BUSTER

**CPI**
Consumer price index: the cost of a typical shopping basket. Its rise is "inflation".

**Core inflation**
Price rises without food and fuel, which swing wildly. It shows the underlying trend.

**Treasury yield**
The interest the US government pays on its bonds; a benchmark for loans everywhere.

**Hawkish**
A central bank leaning towards higher rates to fight inflation. The opposite is "dovish".

OIL

### Crude slides again

America's WTI oil settled at $86.04 a barrel (–0.93%) and Brent at $91.49 (–1.17%), as hopes of an end to the Iran war held, Kiplinger reports.

CHIPS

### Nvidia's rough month

The world's best-known AI chipmaker was the Dow's worst share for a second day. It has lost nearly 30% since early October, TechFlow notes.

GOLD

### Gold holds near $4,120

Gold steadied after a 5% rally last week, with traders watching the Fed's next move, Kotak Neo reports.

Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics (CPI release) · CNBC (CPI breakdown, forecasts) · Fox Business (missing annual rate, analyst estimate) · Kiplinger (closes, oil) · JournalArta (index points, 10-year yield) · TechFlow (Nvidia) · TradingKey (AMD, Broadcom) · Kotak Neo (gold). Not investment advice.

# World Affairs

WHO'S DOING WHAT, AND WHY IT MATTERS

THE BIG STORY · TALKS, OR NO TALKS?

## Trump says the Iran war is "effectively over"; Tehran says there are no talks at all; Qatar, in the middle, sees "progress"

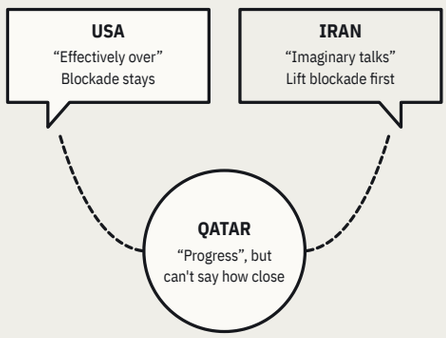
*Three very different stories came out of Washington, Tehran and Doha on the same day. Here is what each side actually said.*

**Washington:** at a White House briefing, President Trump said Iran, "militarily, is effectively over", and called new strikes "quite unlikely". But he added, "if we do have to go back in, we are locked and loaded", and said America's naval blockade of Iran's ports stays, Euronews reports. After meeting Qatar's prime minister, Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani, he said everyone agreed Iran must never get a nuclear weapon.

**Tehran:** Mohsen Rezaei, the secretary of Iran's top security council, told Washington on X to "fold your hand. Stop manufacturing fake news about imaginary talks." Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi denied any meeting was planned. Yet Iran has also proposed restarting talks "in as little as two days" if the US stops attacks, lifts the blockade and waives some sanctions, leaving nuclear issues for later. Iranian officials say strikes are still happening, including on Qeshm island; the US military has not confirmed this.

**Doha:** Qatar's foreign ministry said the White House meeting was "positive" but "we cannot say how close or how far away an agreement is." The Qatari prime minister then flew to Paris to join foreign ministers from the G7 group of rich democracies and Saudi Arabia, Just Security reports.

### WHO SAID WHAT ON TUESDAY




Oil: Brent down to $91.49 (page 2)

Quotes as reported by Euronews, 10 November.

### THE INDIA ANGLE

For India, the most useful words this week were Trump's "quite unlikely": they helped push oil down for a second week, and India imports most of its crude. India also keeps quiet ties across the Gulf. This week an Indian Navy frigate, INS Surat, has been exercising with Oman's navy just outside the Strait of Hormuz (page 4). A real deal would matter most for the shipping lanes that carry India's oil and gas, and for the millions of Indians who live and work in Gulf countries.

### IRAN'S OFFER IN THREE STEPS

| Step 1 | Step 2 | Step 3 | |
|---|---|---|---|
| US stops attacks and lifts the port blockade | some sanctions waived, talks restart within days | nuclear issues discussed later | |

US Secretary of State Rubio called some of Iran's conditions "outrageous and ridiculous".

AROUND THE WORLD

UKRAINE

### Talks in Abu Dhabi

Russian and Ukrainian officials met for their first US-brokered talks since February. US envoy Jared Kushner said recent contacts had "narrowed the gaps", Reuters reports.

Why it matters: it's the first face-to-face round in nine months.

CHINA

### A summit with a script?

China wants any Trump–Putin–Xi meeting to be "highly scripted", while the US wants a looser format, the Wall Street Journal reports. The gap raises doubts it will happen.

Why it matters: the three-way meeting we reported yesterday is not settled.

ASIA

### Indonesia's deputy wants out

Vice President Gibran Rakabuming Raka told President Prabowo Subianto he intends to resign, a presidential spokesman said, according to Reuters.

Why it matters: Indonesia is a major Indian trade partner.

Sources: Euronews (Trump, Rezaei, Araghchi, Iran's proposal, strikes) · Euronews (Qatar's view) · Just Security Early Edition, 10 Nov (Paris G7, Ukraine, China summit, Indonesia; citing Reuters and WSJ) · Al Jazeera live blog · Middle East Monitor · idrw.org / IANS (INS Surat). Accounts of the US–Iran contacts conflict; none of the reports we read confirms a meeting date.

# Defence

ARMY · NAVY · AIR FORCE · MADE IN INDIA

DRDO · THE BIG STORY

## Keep clear of the Bay of Bengal: India has closed a stretch of sea and sky for three days of missile tests, starting this morning

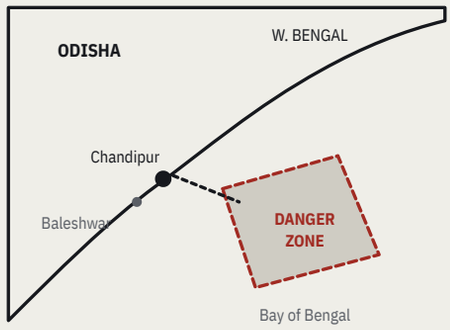
*A fresh warning to pilots and sailors covers 11 to 13 November, off DRDO's test range at Chandipur in Odisha. Which missile will fly has not been announced.*

When India plans to fire a missile over the sea, it first tells the world, so that no airliner or fishing boat strays into the danger zone. That warning is called a **NOTAM** (notice to airmen), with a matching notice for ships. The latest one, reported by idrw.org, runs from **10 AM on Wednesday 11 November to 4 PM on Friday 13 November**, with a height limit of "surface to unlimited", meaning the sky is closed all the way up.

The danger area is a four-sided patch of sea off the Odisha–West Bengal coast near Baleshwar, with sides of roughly 52, 62, 67 and 80 km, close to DRDO's Integrated Test Range at Chandipur. Shipping warnings split Thursday and Friday into two windows, **9–11 AM** and **2–4 PM**. The notice calls them "experimental flight trials" and does not name the missile.

**Why it's interesting:** just last week DRDO said its Pralay missile passed a user trial off the same coast. Analysts often guess the missile from the size of the zone, but until DRDO announces a result, any name is speculation. Watch for a Defence Ministry statement by Friday evening.

### WHERE THE SEA IS CLOSED




A rough sketch, not to scale.

### AIR FORCE — HOW MUCH CAN IT LIFT? (TONNES)




Figures as given by idrw.org.

AIR FORCE · PLANES

### Who replaces the Gajraj?

Yesterday's high-altitude hero, the IL-76, is about 40 years old, with 3 grounded; 11 C-17s do most heavy lifting. The IAF may need a separate heavy-lift tender, idrw.org says.

NAVY · EXERCISE

### INS Surat in Muscat

The new destroyer is in Oman for the 15th Naseem Al Bahr exercise with the Royal Navy of Oman, 8–11 November, to improve "interoperability", IANS reports.

ARMY · DRONES

### A jet-powered kamikaze drone

Delhi's VEDA Aeronautics is preparing for Army tests of a jet-based kamikaze drone, under a fast-track buy approved in July, idrw.org reports.

### ⓘ DEFENCE WORDS DECODED

**NOTAM**
Notice to airmen: an official warning that part of the sky is closed or risky.

**Kamikaze drone**
A drone that dives into its target and explodes, also called a loitering munition.

**AoN**
Acceptance of Necessity: the first official "yes, we need this" before the forces can buy a weapon.

**Interoperability**
The ability of two navies or armies to work smoothly together: same signals, same drills.

DRDO · HYPERSONICS

### A heat shield for Mach 5+

DRDO's Hyderabad lab, DRDL, says it has tested a next-generation thermal protection system, the "skin" that stops hypersonic vehicles from burning up, idrw.org reports.

ARMY · ARTILLERY

### From desert to snow

Kalyani's truck-mounted gun has finished desert trials and is heading to Sikkim for winter trials, idrw.org reports.

Sources: idrw.org (Bay of Bengal NOTAM) · idrw.org (IAF heavy lifters) · idrw.org / IANS (INS Surat) · idrw.org / AFI (VEDA drone) · idrw.org (DRDL heat shield) · idrw.org front page (Kalyani gun) · SSBCrack (Pralay trial). Most items today rest on a single report; Defence Standard was unavailable at press time.

# Sports

CRICKET · FOOTBALL · FORMULA 1

CRICKET · 3RD ODI · SEDDON PARK, HAMILTON

## Not a single ball: rain washes out the third ODI, and India keep their 2–0 lead in New Zealand

*India won the toss, chose to bowl, and then everyone waited. After hours of drizzle and talk of a shorter game, the match was called off.*

Yesterday's paper went to press as the third one-day international was about to start. It never did. India's captain **Shubman Gill** won the toss, his side's seventh in eight matches on this tour, and chose to field first. Then the rain came. The umpires first planned a 40-over game, then waited for the cut-off time for a 20-over match (12:32 PM India time), and finally called it off, CricketNews.com reports.

The washout ends New Zealand's run of home ODI wins, ESPNcricinfo's headline notes, and it means India **cannot lose the series**: at 2–0 with two to play, the worst they can do is draw 2–2. Both earlier wins also came under rain rules. New Zealand will be without fast bowler **Lockie Ferguson**, who has torn a calf muscle and misses the last two games.

**Next:** the 4th and 5th ODIs are at the Bay Oval in Mount Maunganui, Tauranga, on **Friday 13** and **Sunday 15 November**, both at **7:30 AM IST**. One more win seals the series.

ODI SERIES · AFTER 3 OF 5

| | |
|---|---|
| **IND** | 2 |
| **NZ** | 0 |

3RD ODI: NO RESULT (RAIN)

### THE TOUR SO FAR

**1st ODI** · Auckland · India won (DLS)
**2nd ODI** · Wellington · India won by 4 runs (DLS)
**3rd ODI** · Hamilton · abandoned
**4th ODI** · Tauranga · Fri 13 Nov
**5th ODI** · Tauranga · Sun 15 Nov

### TODAY ON TV · IST

**3:00 PM** · SAFF: India v Maldives
**7:30 PM** · SAFF: Bangladesh v Sri Lanka
**1:40 PM** · WBBL: Scorchers v Thunder

### AROUND THE GROUNDS

**U19 Asia Cup** · India 309/7 beat UAE 239 by **70 runs**
**U19 Asia Cup** · Pakistan beat Nepal by 101 runs
**Test** · Pakistan 434/9 v Sri Lanka 114/3 (day 2)
**Premier League** · Brighton **2–0** Brentford
**Premier League** · Bournemouth **2–1** Ipswich
**A tour** · England Lions beat West Indies A by 276 runs

FOOTBALL · SAFF

### India's turn today

India play the Maldives in the SAFF Championship at 3 PM. Pakistan beat the Maldives 3–0 at the weekend, so India know the target.

CRICKET · SMOG

### A Test moved by bad air

The second Pakistan–Sri Lanka Test has been moved from Lahore to Rawalpindi because of smog, SportzCraazy reports.

F1

### Ocon out at Haas

Esteban Ocon posted a “heartfelt message” after Haas let him go, PlanetF1 reports. Next race: Las Vegas, 22 November, 4 AM IST.

Sources: CricketNews.com (3rd ODI washout, schedule, Ferguson) · ESPNcricinfo match report (headline) · India TV · SportzCraazy Morning Pulse, 11 Nov (U19, A tour, fixtures) · SportzCraazy (football, Pakistan Test) · PlanetF1 (Ocon).

# The Reading Room

THREE PIECES OF GREAT WRITING, AND WHAT TO LEARN FROM THEM

*Today's menu: the biggest unanswered question about the universe, a field guide to arguing well, and the market words you'll meet every day in this paper.*

## 01

SCIENCE · SPACE | 20 MIN READ

### "The Fermi Paradox" by Tim Urban, Wait But Why

**In one line:** the universe is so huge that aliens should be everywhere, so why haven't we heard from a single one?

Urban starts on a dark night, looking up at the stars, and then does the maths: there are more stars than grains of sand on every beach on Earth, and billions of Earth-like planets in our galaxy alone. So where is everybody? He walks through the possible answers, from the cheerful (we're early, or they're too advanced to bother with us) to the chilling (something wipes out every civilisation before it spreads). It's a thrilling read that leaves you feeling very small and very lucky at the same time.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

**Make huge numbers human.** "More stars than grains of sand" turns a number nobody can picture into an image everybody can.

waitbutwhy.com/2014/05/fermi-paradox.html

## 02

THINKING · ARGUING | 7 MIN READ

### "How to Disagree" by Paul Graham

**In one line:** there's a ladder of disagreement, from name-calling at the bottom to refuting the central point at the top, and most arguments live near the bottom.

Graham ranks seven ways people disagree. At the bottom is plain insult; then attacking the person instead of the idea; then complaining about someone's tone; then simply saying the opposite. Only near the top do you find real counter-arguments, and at the very top, showing exactly where the other person's main point goes wrong. On a day when Washington and Tehran can't even agree whether they're talking (page 3), it's a useful map for any argument at work or at home.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

**Give your reader a ladder.** Ranking ideas from worst to best, with a name for each rung, makes a list stick and lets readers place themselves on it.

paulgraham.com/disagree.html

## 03

MONEY · INDIA | 10 MIN READ

### "Commonly Used Jargons" by Zerodha Varsity

**In one line:** a plain-English glossary for the words market people throw around: bull, bear, volume, "52-week high", and more.

The next chapter in Varsity's beginner series, after the one on stock market indices we suggested yesterday. It explains the words you hear on business TV and read on our page 1: what a bull and a bear market are, what the open, high, low and close of a share mean, why "volume" (how many shares changed hands) matters, and what people mean by a share's 52-week high. Short, friendly, and it'll make every Gazette front page easier to read.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

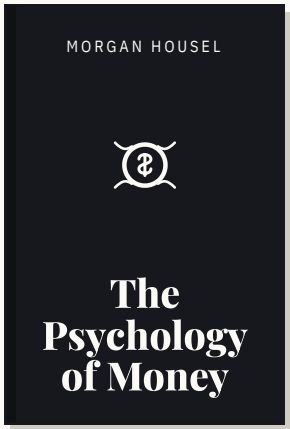
**Define words where they're used.** Varsity explains each term with a small example from a real day's trading, so the meaning sticks.

zerodha.com/varsity/chapter/commonly-used-jargons

Read times are rough estimates. Links go to the original publishers.

# The Book Review

TODAY: SELF-HELP




★★★★★

**Genre:** Self-help · money
**First published:** 2020
**Length:** about 250 pages
**Style:** 20 short stories-with-a-lesson
**Read it:** one chapter with morning tea

REVIEW · *THE PSYCHOLOGY OF MONEY: TIMELESS LESSONS ON WEALTH, GREED, AND HAPPINESS*

## The money book for people who don't like money books: no formulas, just stories about how we behave

Most finance books try to teach you maths. Morgan Housel's argument is that doing well with money has little to do with how clever you are and a lot to do with how you behave, and behaviour is hard to teach, even to very smart people. So instead of charts, he tells stories.

There's the janitor who quietly saved and invested all his life and left millions to charity, and the Harvard-educated executive who earned a fortune and went bankrupt. There's the fact that most of a famous investor's wealth came after his 65th birthday, simply because he started early and kept going. Each of the 20 short chapters ends with one idea, such as: saving doesn't need a reason, "enough" is a real number, and the most valuable thing money buys is control over your own time.

It's perfect for a reader like ours who doesn't know finance: there's no jargon you can't follow, and every chapter can be read on its own in ten minutes. You may already know Housel's writing: two of his essays have appeared in our Reading Room. This is where his best ideas live together.

*"Doing well with money has a little to do with how smart you are and a lot to do with how you behave."*

Morgan Housel, from the introduction. It sums up the whole book.

### THREE THINGS THIS BOOK TEACHES

**1**

**Time beats talent**

Small savings left alone for decades grow enormous, thanks to compounding. Starting early matters more than earning big.

**2**

**Know your "enough"**

People who never decide how much is enough keep taking risks until they lose what they had.

**3**

**Freedom is the real reward**

The best thing money buys is the ability to do what you want, when you want, with whom you want.

### READ IT IF YOU…

- find money topics boring or scary
- liked the "72 rule" in yesterday's Facts page
- enjoyed *Atomic Habits* (reviewed on 6 November)

### LIKED IT? READ NEXT

- *Same as Ever* by Morgan Housel
- *Rich Dad Poor Dad* by Robert Kiyosaki
- *Let's Talk Money* by Monika Halan, for Indian readers

The quote is from the book's introduction. Published by Harriman House, 2020.

# Puzzles & Games

EIGHT BRAIN GAMES · EASY → HARD · ANSWERS ON PAGE 11

1 · EASY · WORDS

## Who ties the knot?

Unscramble these letters to find the person who made today's knot famous (page 11).

L O R I A S

2 · EASY · NUMBERS

## What comes next?

Look at the gaps between the numbers.

2 6 12 20 30 ?

3 · MEDIUM · WORDS

## Heads or tails

Change one letter at a time to turn HEAD into TAIL. Every step must be a real word.

HEAD → ? → ? → ? → ? → TAIL

4 · MEDIUM · LOGIC

## Back to school

3 pens and 2 notebooks cost ₹170. One pen and one notebook together cost ₹70. What does one pen cost?

5 · MEDIUM · GRID

## Mini Sudoku

Fill in the grid so every row, column and 2×2 box has 1, 2, 3 and 4.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 3 | |
| 4 | | | |
| | | | 2 |
| | 1 | | |

6 · MEDIUM · TODAY'S NEWS

## Work it backwards

On Tuesday the S&P 500 fell 29.01 points to close at 7,520.93 (page 2). Where did it close on Monday?

7 · HARD · NUMBERS

## The sailor's rope

A rope is cut into three pieces in the ratio 2 : 3 : 5. The longest piece is 15 metres longer than the shortest. How long was the whole rope?

8 · HARD · WORDPLAY

## Read the picture

What common phrase does this show?

R | E | A | D | I | N | G

Hint: it's how you spot what someone means but didn't say.

# Facts, Figures & Takes

THINGS TO SAY OVER WEDNESDAY CHAI

## 0.4%

How much America's shopping basket rose in a single month, more than forecast (page 2).

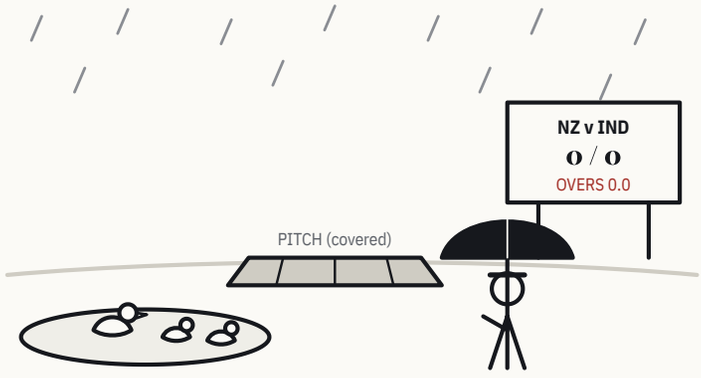
## 0 balls

Bowled in Hamilton on Tuesday. India still lead the ODI series 2–0 (page 5).

## 3 days

The sea and sky off Odisha are closed for missile trials, 11–13 November (page 4).

POCKET CARTOON




*"Finally, someone in Hamilton is enjoying the conditions."*

THE TAKE · OUR OPINION

## When three capitals tell three stories, watch the oil price, not the press conferences

On Tuesday Washington said the Iran war was "effectively over", Tehran said talks were "imaginary", and Qatar said there was "progress". All three can be partly true: leaders often deny talks in public while their go-betweens carry messages in private, because looking eager to talk can look weak at home.

So how should an ordinary reader judge what's really happening? Follow what people do with their money. Oil traders, who lose fortunes if they guess wrong, have pushed Brent down from nearly $100 to about $91 in a week. That doesn't prove peace is coming, but it tells you the people with the most at stake think a big new war is less likely.

**Our view:** treat each day's quotes as noise and the trend in oil as the signal. For India, that signal has been good news for a week.

This is the Gazette's opinion.

### MONEY IDEA OF THE DAY: THE "REAL" RETURN

If your fixed deposit pays 7% a year and prices rise 5% a year, your money only grows by about **2%** in what it can actually buy. That gap is your "real" return. It's why people worry so much about inflation reports like America's on Tuesday: inflation quietly eats your savings.

DID YOU KNOW?

### The beach that walks away

At Chandipur in Odisha, near the missile range, the sea pulls back as far as 5 km at low tide, so you can walk out onto the seabed.

### Named after envy

Nvidia's name comes from *invidia*, the Latin word for envy. Its logo is a green eye.

### The king of knots

Sailors call the bowline "the king of knots". Its name comes from the bow line, a rope that held a sail's edge towards the front (bow) of the ship (page 11).

### What's in the basket?

America's price index tracks the prices of tens of thousands of items each month, from rent and bread to haircuts and car insurance (page 2).

### Muscat's old forts

Oman's capital, where INS Surat is docked, is guarded by two 16th-century Portuguese forts, Al Jalali and Al Mirani, facing its harbour.

### Money and the brain

*The Psychology of Money* (page 7) has sold millions of copies and been translated into dozens of languages since 2020.

Figures from pages 2–5. Facts from standard reference works, the US BLS and Odisha Tourism.

# Ten Words for Today

LEARN THEM, THEN USE ONE BEFORE DINNER

1 **Hawkish** adj. · HAW-kish

Favouring a tough approach; for central banks, leaning towards higher interest rates.

*"After hot inflation data, traders expect a hawkish Fed."*

2 **Tenuous** adj. · TEN-yoo-us

Very weak or slight; easily broken.

*"Hopes of a US–Iran meeting remain tenuous."*

3 **Abate** verb · uh-BAYT

To become less strong or intense.

*"We waited for the rain to abate, but it never did."*

4 **Stalemate** noun · STAYL-mayt

A situation where neither side can make progress.

*"Talks about talks have reached a stalemate."*

5 **Deft** adj. · DEFT

Quick, neat and skilful, especially with the hands.

*"A deft sailor ties a bowline in seconds."*

6 **Prescient** adj. · PRESH-ent

Knowing or guessing what will happen before it does.

*"Her warning about the chip shares now looks prescient."*

7 **Impetus** noun · IM-puh-tus

A force or reason that makes something happen faster.

*"Cheaper oil gave the market fresh impetus."*

8 **Wary** adj. · WAIR-ee

Cautious because you expect possible danger or problems.

*"Investors are wary of a rate rise in December."*

9 **Reprieve** noun · rih-PREEV

A short break or delay from something unpleasant.

*"The washout was a reprieve for New Zealand."*

10 **Galvanise** verb · GAL-vuh-nize

To shock or excite someone into taking action.

*"The lost match may galvanise the team for Friday."*

## TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Use **wary** in a work message today, for example about a deadline or a plan you're not sure of.

# Skill of the Day

OUTDOORS · ABOUT 10 MINUTES TO LEARN · DIFFICULTY: EASY

KNOTS · AS PROMISED YESTERDAY

# How to tie a bowline, the loop that never slips

*A bowline makes a fixed loop at the end of a rope. It holds firm under a heavy pull, yet unties easily afterwards. Useful for tying up a boat, hanging a hammock, securing a load on a car roof, or a clothesline.*

### WHAT YOU'LL NEED

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A rope about 1 metre long (a dressing-gown cord works) | A chair leg or post to practise around | The rhyme below |

### 1 Make the "rabbit hole"

Hold the rope with the long end (the **standing part**) going away from you. About 30 cm from the free end (the **working end**), make a small loop by laying the rope over itself. The working end should be on top.

### 2 Out of the hole

Push the working end **up through** the small loop from underneath. "The rabbit comes out of the hole."

### 3 Round the tree

Take the working end **behind** the standing part. "Round the tree." The size of the big loop you leave below is the size your finished loop will be.

### 4 Back down the hole

Bring the working end back **down through** the small loop, the same way it came out. "And back down the hole."

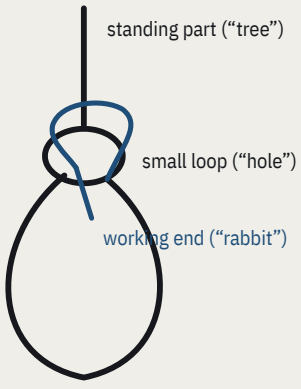
### 5 Dress and tighten

Hold the working end and the side of the big loop together in one hand, and pull the standing part with the other. The knot should sit neatly with no crossed strands.

### 6 Check it and leave a tail

Leave a tail of at least **10–12 times** the rope's thickness. To untie, push the "collar" (the bit wrapped round the standing part) forward to loosen it.

### THE RABBIT AND THE TREE




**fixed loop: won't tighten**

Up through the hole, round the tree, back down the hole.

### ⚠ SAFETY

- **Never use a home-tied knot for climbing or lifting a person.** That needs proper training and certified gear.
- A bowline can shake loose when it is *not* under load, for example on a flapping rope. Check it before trusting it.
- Don't stand in line with a rope under heavy tension: if it snaps, it whips back.

### PRO TIP

Practise with your eyes closed once you've got it. Sailors learn it so well they can tie it in the dark, or around their own waist with one hand.

**Tomorrow's skill:** how to wrap a gift neatly, with sharp corners and hardly any tape.

### PUZZLE ANSWERS (PAGE 8) · TURN THE PAPER UPSIDE DOWN

1. SAILOR · 2. 42 (the gaps grow by 2: +4, +6, +8, +10, +12) · 3. HEAD → HEAL → TEAL → TELL → TALL → TAIL · 4. ₹30 (notebook ₹40: 3 × 30 + 2 × 40 = 170) · 5. Rows: 1 2 3 4 / 4 3 2 1 / 3 4 1 2 / 2 1 4 3 · 6. 7,549.94 (7,520.93 + 29.01) · 7. 50 metres (5 − 2 = 3 parts = 15 m, so 1 part = 5 m; 10 parts = 50 m) · 8. READING BETWEEN THE LINES